

Chapter 156-10

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Liang Shi was teased until she didn't know what to do, yet she only wanted to chat with her, not to fool around or do anything outrageous.

Fortunately, after finishing the wine, Xu Qingzhu started getting sleepy. She fussed for Liang Shi to carry her back to the bedroom, then wanted to nestle in Liang Shi's arms to sleep.

After Xu Qingzhu fell asleep, Liang Shi got up to make some honey water. She drank a glass herself first, then placed another glass on the nightstand, afraid Xu Qingzhu would have a headache when she woke up with a hangover.

After doing all this, she went to quickly wash up, then tiptoed to lie down beside Xu Qingzhu to sleep.

The room quieted down. Even the moonlight hid behind the clouds, leaving only a layer of haze.

Yet Xu Qingzhu had her brows tightly furrowed, a thin layer of sweat seeping from her forehead.

It was as if she had sunk into a deep sea. Everything before her eyes was blood-red, and someone kept dragging her down.

She clearly could float up. Her arms reached upward with all her might, but she still inevitably sank.

A moment later, the scene changed. She was thrown into a maze. The fog before her eyes was tinged with blood, as if it would bring out the most terrifying desires from the depths of one's heart.

Xu Qingzhu was frightened and wanted to escape, but someone grabbed her foot and dragged her back. Then came the sound of a knife slicing across skin.

Slash—

It sounded just like a knife tearing through expensive silk fabric.

But the pain was real. Her flesh seemed to split open in an instant.

Xu Qingzhu turned around in shock, only to see Liang Shi's face. She opened her mouth to call Liang Shi's name, but it was as if something had sealed her mouth—she couldn't make a sound at all.

She could only watch in terror as the other person walked toward her, then raised the knife in her hand. The sharp blade reflected a blinding light.

In just an instant, the knife plunged into her lower abdomen. The pain made tears stream down her face.

She wanted to say: "I'm Xu Qingzhu."

But she couldn't say anything. She could only watch as Liang Shi kept swinging the knife at her.

The pain of the knife piercing through skin and bone made her scalp tingle. If she had died and lost consciousness, that would have been fine, but she hadn't.

It was like facing her own death head-on, feeling the pain before dying.

No, that wasn't Liang Shi.

Liang Shi had said that if she had a knife in her hand, the blade would definitely be pointed at herself.

Xu Qingzhu kept hypnotizing herself, but... the one standing there was Liang Shi.

That knife pierced through her bones and flesh, dyeing all the fog blood-red.

Xu Qingzhu couldn't make a sound.

Then the scene changed. It was in the villa where they had lived before.

Xu Qingzhu's body wasn't injured, but the pain still lingered deep in her memory. She didn't dare move anywhere she had been stabbed.

Everything was pitch black.

Outside, the endless sound of cicadas could be heard, as if heralding the end of summer.

Xu Qingzhu curled up in a corner, not daring to make any sound. But suddenly her hair was grabbed, and that knife was pointed at her face again.

Then the knife slashed across her face, across her shoulder, across her lower abdomen... the blood spread.

Every cut was so painful.

Xu Qingzhu told herself this was a dream.

None of it was real.

She wanted to wake up from the dream, but she couldn't no matter what. There was even a voice whispering in her ear: "This is what's real... everything you see is fake."

Xu Qingzhu's whole body was in pain. She felt like the blood in her body was almost drained.

She opened her mouth but couldn't say a word.

She couldn't even match a dying cicada.

Xu Qingzhu lay on the ground, watching Liang Shi's face grow larger and larger before her eyes. She opened her mouth wide, wanting to say to her: "Wife..."

But she couldn't say it. She could only watch helplessly as that face kept growing larger, and larger, and then that sharp knife pierced through her heart.

Just like the dull pain she had felt countless times in nightmares.

"Mm!" Xu Qingzhu suddenly opened her eyes, staring at the ceiling.

Tears and sweat flowed down together.

It was another different scene.

But this time, she was lying beside herself.

Xu Qingzhu looked at Liang Shi beside her. She was sound asleep.

The places that had just been stabbed by the knife were still throbbing with pain. She simply couldn't give the other person another chance. So she reached under the pillow and pulled out that fruit knife.

The sharp blade was pointed at Liang Shi's glands,¹ but tears fell uncontrollably onto Liang Shi's face.

At that moment, when Liang Shi opened her eyes, this was the scene she saw.

Xu Qingzhu sat beside her with disheveled hair, both hands gripping the knife, the blade pointed at her glands, her eyes completely red.

She seemed to be enduring tremendous pain.

Liang Shi called out to her in shock: "Wife."

Xu Qingzhu had a moment of confusion. The blade in her hand only lightly grazed the back of Liang Shi's neck.

Liang Shi called to her again: "Baby..."

Xu Qingzhu opened her mouth but still couldn't speak. Yet tears kept falling.

She suddenly pointed the blade at herself.

Just as she was about to plunge the blade into her own abdomen, Liang Shi reached out and grabbed her hand.

"Wife, give me the knife." Liang Shi didn't dare relax her grip, but still coaxed her in a soft voice.

Xu Qingzhu looked at her woodenly, her eyes blank.

She asked: "You're not going to kill me?"

Liang Shi was momentarily speechless. She shook her head with a bitter smile. "I love you. How could I kill you?"

"But don't you want to kill me?" Xu Qingzhu asked.

"I won't." Liang Shi said gently, taking the knife from her hand at the same time.

There was blood on the tip of the knife—blood from the back of Liang Shi's neck.

But only a little.

Xu Qingzhu frowned, her expression pained. "Then who is the one trying to kill me?"

Liang Shi pressed her lips together, not knowing what to say. After a moment, she could only answer: "It's your dream. It's fake. No one is trying to kill you."

She took the knife from Xu Qingzhu's hand and threw it aside. It hit the floor with a clang.

In the darkness and silence, it was especially eerie.

Xu Qingzhu still looked at her in confusion: "Then who are you?"

"I'm Liang Shi." Liang Shi said.

Xu Qingzhu bit her lower lip, looked at her, and then said as if suddenly understanding: "You're the Liang Shi I love."

Liang Shi nodded, tears in her eyes: "Yes, the one you love."

"Then do you love me?" Xu Qingzhu asked.

Liang Shi's tears suddenly fell. "I do."

Xu Qingzhu threw herself into her arms and kissed her throat. "Jiejie, please don't cry, okay?"

Xu Qingzhu took her hand and placed it on her own heart. "It hurts so much here."

Liang Shi held her tight.

After a long time, Xu Qingzhu fell into a deep sleep in her arms.

Footnotes:

1. Glands (腺體): In the ABO universe of this novel, glands are special organs located at the back of the neck that produce pheromones. They are crucial for marking bonds between Alphas and Omegas. Damaging them can cause permanent harm, as mentioned in the novel's synopsis.